



Strategic Updates

September 2026



Safety & Security



Ensure a fully integrated approach to safety and security that encompasses both the physical environment and the social/emotional needs of students.





Safety & Security



KPI 2.1: By June 2028, 100% of identified safety and security recommendations will be implemented with fidelity to enhance campus, facility, and transportation security.

Indicator	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of implemented safety and security recommendations from the 2022 Threat Risk Vulnerability (TRV) Assessment	28%	35%	54% (+19)



Safety & Security



Safety & Security Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Debrief live reunification drill for continuous improvement
- Install loading dock cameras
- Update universal signage at all campuses
- Post campus speed limit signs
- Solicit an RFP for an updated Threat Risk Vulnerability Assessment



Safety & Security



KPI 2.3: Annually, 80% + of school counselors’ working hours will be spent delivering counseling services to students to enhance the development of their social, emotional, physical, and mental health.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
% of school counselors’ working hours spent directly delivering school counseling services to students	77.8%	79%	Data not available (platform)
Total number of students who received direct counseling services	Data not previously collected	Data not previously collected	98.7%
Total number of students served through small group counseling sessions	Data not previously collected	1040	975



Safety & Security



School Counseling Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Hired a Coordinator of School Counseling & Student Supports
- Design Graduate Action Planning Process
- Conduct Student Mental Health Focus Groups (adults & students)
- Host 12 Youth Mental Health First Aid Workshops
- Support School-Based Mental Health Teams
- Host Elementary Classroom Counseling PLC Sessions



Safety & Security



School Counseling Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Host Financial Aid Workshops (HB 1095)
- Support SAT School Day (HB 410)
- Provide Parental Notification of Course Request Timeline (SB 817)
- Support Discharge Plans for Students in Mental Health Facilities (SB 171)
- Provide Culturally Responsive Mental Health Support (HB 1113)



Safety & Security



KPI 2.4: Annually, the overall percentage of behavioral referrals that result in suspension from school will decrease by 2%.

Indicator	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of behavioral referrals resulting in suspension from school	24%	24%	23.8% (-0.2)



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Student Behavior Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Hired additional staff focused on supporting student behavior
 - 6 Behavioral Specialists
 - 9 Elementary Behavior Paraprofessionals
- Monthly meetings with principals to discuss behavior data and triage needs
- Mentoring program design team
- Enhancing student assistance plans
- Additional supports for students returning from long-term suspension
- Exploring alternatives to suspension for elementary students and students enrolled in non-traditional pathways
- Redesigned alternative classroom setting program (MS & HS)





Safety & Security



KPI 2.5: By June 2028, WJCC will increase the daily attendance average to 95%+ and decrease chronic absenteeism rates by 3%.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Average daily attendance percentage	93.8%	94.8% (+1.0)	95.2% (+0.4)
Percentage of students identified as “chronically absent” (absent more than 10% of the days in which they are enrolled)	10.6%	9.9% (-0.7)	8.0% (-1.9)



Safety & Security



Student Attendance Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Community outreach in neighborhoods with students who have higher levels of absenteeism
- Second multidisciplinary team (MDT) meeting each month
 - Increase parent participation and access (virtual option)
- Attendance Improvement Plans in Synergy
- Beginning of the year attendance conferences with students who were identified as chronically absent in 2025-26
- Design the Student Activities KPI process to monitor student engagement and involvement



Safety & Security



KPI 2.6: By June 2028, 90% of enrolled K-12 WJCC students will identify that their school provides access to a safe, healthy, well-maintained, and positive learning environment.

Indicators (Elevate '28 Stakeholder Survey Items)	2024-25 Baseline Ratings of 3 or higher on a 4-point Likert scale	2025-26 Progress Ratings of 3 or higher on a 4-point Likert scale
Percentage of students who identify that their school provides access to a safe learning environment	77%	84% (+7)
Percentage of students who identify that their school provides access to a healthy and well-maintained learning environment	74%	77% (+3)
Percentage of students who identify that their school provides access to a positive learning environment	84%	88% (+4)
Combined Average	78.3%	83.0% (+4.7)



Safety & Security



Student Belonging Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Continue the Student Voices Tour (ES, MS, HS)
- Student Leadership Development
 - Expansion of Superintendent's Student Advisory Council (14 members from each HS)
 - VCIC Summer Connections Institute
 - Summer Leadership Academy (HS)
 - VHSL Ken Tilley Leadership Conference (HS)
 - Elementary Student Leadership Workshop
 - Middle School Student Leadership Workshop
 - SCA Advisor Meetings
 - Captain's Council (HS Athletics)
- Leadership Connect Shadowing Experience
- Exploring Additional Student Internship Experiences within WJCC



Safety & Security



KPI 2.7: Annually, 95% of K-5 WJCC students will have participated in a SHIP-sponsored program, training, or activity that promotes nutrition education, healthy eating, and physical activity strengthening a culture of health and readiness to learn.

Indicator	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of K-5 classrooms who have participated in a SHIP-sponsored program, training, or activity that promotes a culture of health and readiness to learn	Data not previously collected	91%	95% (+4)



Safety & Security



SHIP Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Support non-tech incentives for classroom behavior through movement activities and games
- Train paraprofessionals on in-class movement strategies
- Collaboration with special education to adapt SHIP programming to meet the needs of students in self-contained elementary classrooms



Human Capital & Positive Culture



Recruit and retain the division's exemplary workforce by creating an environment where transparency and trust are the norm.





Human Capital & Positive Culture



KPI 3.1: Annually, 100% of personnel for all budgeted positions will be recruited and hired by the first day of school.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27
Percentage of teachers hired by the first day of school	99.5%	92.0%	99.4% (+7.4)	99.6% (+0.2)
Percentage of support employees hired by the first day of school	92.0%	92.5%	94.9% (+2.4)	95.3% (+0.4)
Percentage of administrators hired by the first day of school	100%	100%	100%	99.0% (-1.0)



Human Capital & Positive Culture



KPI 3.2: Annually, 90%+ of employees will be retained by focusing on employee engagement and talent development.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27
Percentage of teachers who renewed their contracts	83.3%	85.0%	85.4% (+0.4)	87.0% (+1.6)
Percentage of support employees who renewed their contracts	82.4%	79.0%	81.7% (+2.7)	82.0% (+0.3)
Percentage of administrators who renewed their contracts	87.5%	91.8%	95.8% (+4.0)	89.5% (-6.3)



Human Capital & Positive Culture

KPI 3.3: By June 2028, WJCC will lead the region in salary for teachers, support staff, and administrators.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline (rank out of 6)	2024-25 (rank out of 6)	2025-26 (rank out of 6)	2026-27 (rank out of 6)
Rank of starting salary for teachers (Bachelor's Degree)	3	4	4	4
Rank of starting salary for support employees	5	4	2 (+2)	2
Rank of starting salary for administrators (entry level grade)	Data not previously collected	Data not previously collected	3	3

Ranking compared to Newport News, York, Hampton, New Kent, & Gloucester



Human Capital & Positive Culture



Human Resources Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Compensation Study Recommendations (Year 3)
- Stipend Job Duties Review
- Highlight Employee Wellness Initiatives
 - Vitality Launch
 - Wellness Committee
 - Ongoing Wellness Activities
- Alternative Pathways Information Night (February 11, 2027)
- Targeted Job Fairs
 - Support Employee Recruiting Opportunities
 - VIP Teachers Event
 - March 6, 2027 (Saturday – All Positions)



Human Capital & Positive Culture



KPI 3.4: By June 2028, 90%+ of all employees will report that WJCC is effective at fostering a supportive environment.

Indicators (Elevate '28 Stakeholder Survey Items)	2024-25 Baseline Ratings of 3 or higher on a 4-point Likert scale	2025-26 Progress Ratings of 3 or higher on a 4-point Likert scale
Percentage of employees who identify that administrators care about staff well-being.	88%	78% (-10)
Percentage of employees who identify feeling supported by teachers and staff.	91%	86% (-5)
Percentage of employees who identify that WJCC is a good place to work and learn.	93%	92% (-1)
Combined Average	91%	85.3 (-5.7)



Human Capital & Positive Culture

Employee “Wins, Wishes, & Wonders” Survey (Spring 2026)

WINS

- Collaboration & Team Planning
- Student Achievement & Academic Growth
- Increased Transparency & Communication
- Student Voices & Engagement
- Special Education & Student Support Improvements
- Positive School Culture
- Operational Improvements
- Professional Support for Staff

WISHES

- Competitive Compensation & Retention
- Additional Planning Time & Workload Management
- Special Education Support
- Behavioral and Mental Health Support
- Staffing & Substitute Coverage
- Communication Across Departments
- Human Resources & Onboarding
- School Scheduling & Programmatic Changes
- Professional Growth & Recognition

WONDERS

- Continued Communication & Transparency
- Compensation & Future Raises
- Trust & Follow-Through
- School Safety
- Growth, Redistricting & Capacity
- Support for Diverse Learners
- Teaching & Learning Initiatives
- Preschool & Program Expansion
- Calendar & Operational Decisions



Human Capital & Positive Culture

Employee Engagement Focus Areas (2026-27)

- School-Based Advisory Groups (all schools)
 - Elevate '28 Stakeholder Survey Data
- Expectation for Monthly Staff Meetings (all schools)
 - Improve Communication
 - Provide Opportunities for Team-Building
 - Recognize Employee Contributions (Ongoing)
- Hired Employee Experience Coordinator
- “Helping Hands” – Central Support Visibility in Schools
- National Board-Certified Teacher Support & Recognition Enhancements
 - Classroom Door Magnets
 - Division-wide Recognition
- Operations Services Celebration & Award Recognitions (OSCARS) Ceremony



Human Capital & Positive Culture



KPI 3.5: By June 2028, 95%+ of all employees will participate in professional learning that supports their professional growth and aligns with school division goals.

Indicator	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of employees who participated in at least one professional development opportunity related to their work	Data not previously collected	96.1%	96.7% (+0.6)



Human Capital & Positive Culture

Professional Learning Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Professional Development Facilitator/Presenter Evaluation Tool
- Revise Session Evaluation Survey (designed by PL Focus Group)
- ElevatEd Conference (Secondary)
- Profile of an Empowered Learning Strategies in PL Corner Publication
- Teacher Leadership (80 participants)
- Cognitive Coaching (80 participants)
- Pathways to Leadership Listening Tour
- Exploring Partnerships for a Reading Specialist Degree Cohort



Human Capital & Positive Culture



Professional Learning Focus Areas (2026-27)

- ParaPathways Assessment Prep Sessions & On-Site Administration
- Paraprofessional Lead Mentors (pending Title 2A funding)
- Expand Professional Development for Non-Instructional Employees
- Enhanced Onboarding for Support Employees
- Digitize Professional Development/Conference Travel Form



Communications & Engagement



Cultivate a culture of open and effective communication to inform and engage all stakeholders.





Communications & Engagement



KPI 4.1: By June 2028, WJCC will increase communications by 15% that highlight student and staff success, and division news, leading to transparent communication.

Indicator	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Number of communication publications that highlight student and staff success and school division news	859	1349 (+64%)	1684 (+20%)

Inclusive of website posts, social media posts, mass media stories and responses, community mailers, mass emails (including digital newsletters distributed via email), mass text messages, and mass phone calls sent by the Communications Department between July 1-June 30



Communications & Engagement



KPI 4.2: By June 2028, participation in division-sponsored engagement events will increase by 5% and 80%+ of family participants will report that event content and resources met their expectations.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Number of attendees at division-wide engagement events (not school-specific)	620	951 (+53.4%)	1047 (+9.1%)
Percentage of family engagement attendees reporting that event content and resources met their expectations	100%	98% (-2)	95% (-3)



Communications & Engagement



KPI 4.3: By June 2028, WJCC will increase volunteer participation by 15%+ to meaningfully enhance community engagement, student learning opportunities, and meet staff needs.

	Baseline Data (2025-26)
Hours	10,609 hours Logged into Raptor at schools
People	1,294 individuals
Estimated Value	\$392,426.91 Based on Independent Sector's Value of Volunteer Time in Virginia



Communications & Engagement



KPI 4.4: By June 2028, WJCC will increase partnership participation by 15%+ to meaningfully enhance community engagement, student learning opportunities, and meet staff needs.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Number of business and community organization partnerships	Data not available	20	68 (+70.6%)



Communications & Engagement



Communications & Engagement Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Increased Stipend Amounts
 - Digital Communications Liaisons
 - Family & Community Engagement Liaisons
- Family & Community Engagement School Needs Assessment
 - Integrated into School Success Plans
- Community Literacy Collaborative
- Promote Volunteerism Opportunities
- Student Storytelling in Digital Media Posts/Publications
- Personalization of Employee Intranet (Insider)
- Host Legislative Breakfast



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



Optimize division effectiveness and efficiency by establishing and strengthening processes and systems.





Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.1: Annually no more than 2.5% of the adopted operating budget will remain as reversion funds.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of overall budget remaining as reversion funds	4.9%	2.3% (-2.6)	2.2% (-0.1)

NOTE: Based on the adopted operating budget, not inclusive of additional revenue received after the budget was approved



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.2: By June 2028, 100% of eligible vendors will be paid electronically.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of eligible vendors paid electronically	No data available	64%	90% (+26)



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



Budget & Finance Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Fundraising management platform
- Digitize contract/MOU/agreement approvals
- Transition from Employee Self-Service to Employee Access
 - Opportunities to digitize employee reimbursements
- Community Eligibility Provision (CEP) Analysis Study for Child Nutrition Services



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.3 & 5.4: Annually 100% of capital projects will be completed on-time and not exceed the capital improvement budget by 10%.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of capital improvement projects completed on time	87%	100% (+13)	100%
Percentage of capital improvement projects not exceeding 10% of allocated budget	80%	92% (+12)	87.5% (-4.5)



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.5: Annually, the Mean Time To Repair maintenance work orders will be ≤ 7 days.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Mean time to repair maintenance work orders	12.82 days	11.14 days (-1.68)	14.42 days (-3.28)



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness

Operations Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Exploring Grow Your Own Options / Student Internships
 - Trades-Related Positions (Maintenance Assistants)
 - Child Nutrition Services
- Capital Improvement Plan Projects
 - Complete New Construction on Pre-K Centers
 - Installed New Walk-in Freezer (LLE)
 - Storm Sewer Repairs (LHS)
 - Partial Roof Replacement (LLE & BMS)
 - Construct Sidewalk (SES)
 - Replaced Glass Atrium (TMS)
 - HVAC Replacement – Phase 3 (MWE)
 - Interior Painting (NES)



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.6: Annually, WJCC Schools will maintain a 90%+ bus on-time rate.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Percentage of buses that arrive no later than 10 minutes after the school's dismissal time	84%	81% (-3)	87.4% (+6.6)



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness

Transportation Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Enhancements to “On-Time” Dashboard (Zonar)
- Monthly Transportation Data Review at Central Support Level
- Assess Supports for Identified Routes (Student Needs)
- Design Bus Routes for Preschool Centers
- Design Bus Routes for WJCC United Transition Process



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.7: Annually, 99.999% will be maintained as the average time that the network is accessible and operational.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Average time the network is accessible and operational	99.9%	99.87%	99.45% (0.45)



Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



KPI 5.8: Annually, the Department of Technology will maintain 5 days or less as the average repair time required for all division-issued computing devices.

Indicators	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Average repair time for division-issued computing devices	5.2 days	4.9 days	4.7 days (-0.5)



Safety & Security



KPI 2.2: Annually, WJCC will prevent all attempted data breaches by conducting network and security maintenance.

Indicator	2023-24 Baseline	2024-25	2025-26
Number of data breaches	0	1	0

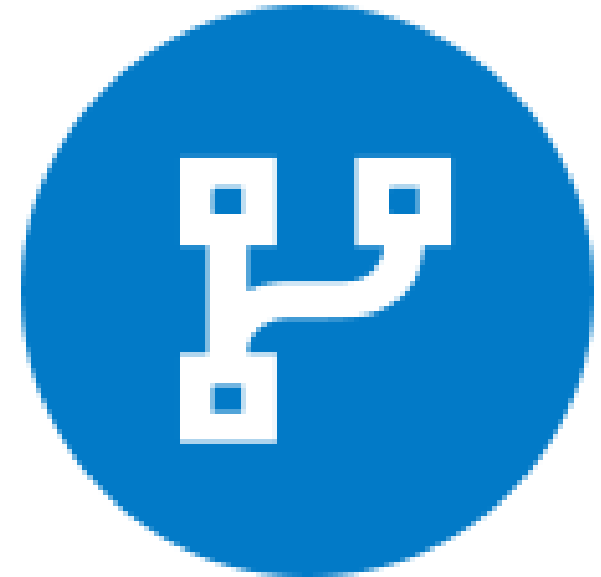


Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness



Information Technology Focus Areas (2026-27)

- Expand Synergy Data Analytics to Improve Progress Monitoring at School & Division Levels
- Lightspeed Filter
 - Class Management of Instructional Technology
 - Parent Portal for Monitoring
- Enhanced Microsoft Security Tools for Network
- Continue to Conduct Screen Time Analysis
- MUNIS Enhancements Project
 - Enhance User Accessibility
 - Data Interoperability with Other Systems
- Employee Data Work Group





Next Strategic Update

October 6, 2026



Academic Achievement, College and
Career Readiness, and Educational Equity